



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ireland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great question—and an exciting stage in your life. Since you're in Denmark, and you've just completed primary school (folkeskole), you're now at the point where you decide your upper secondary education path (ungdomsuddannelse). Your choice should depend on your interests, career goals, and how you like to learn. Here's a clear breakdown of your main options:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General upper secondary education)

These are academic programs that prepare you for university. Ideal if you're considering further academic studies.

STX – Studentereksamen

- Broad academic program with focus on humanities, sciences, and social studies.
- Good if you're not yet sure what you want to study later.
- Typically 3 years.

HTX – Teknisk studentereksamen

- Focus on technology and natural sciences.
- Great if you're interested in engineering, tech, or science.

HHX – Højere handelseksamen

- Business- and economics-oriented.
- Ideal if you're into finance, marketing, or entrepreneurship.

HF – Højere forberedelseseksamen

- 2-year program (or 3 if you take the "HF-enkeltfag" path).
- More practical and often chosen by those who want to study at a university college or aren't sure about long-term studies yet.

 **Recommended** if you like school-based academic learning and think you'll want to go to university later.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational education and training – EUD)

These are for you if you want a more hands-on, practical education and might like to start working sooner or become a skilled worker.

- You combine school with apprenticeship (praktik).
- You can specialize in areas like mechanics, carpentry, healthcare, IT, cooking, etc.
- Typically 3–4 years, and you get paid during your apprenticeship.

👉 **Recommended if** you like practical, real-world learning and want a job-focused path.

3. EUX – Vocational + General Upper Secondary

A combo of both: you get a vocational education **and** a studentereksamen-level exam. It's demanding but opens both university and job paths.

👉 **Recommended if** you want the flexibility of both worlds and can handle a more intense study load.

Bonus: International or English-Language Options

Since you have Irish roots, you might also consider:

- **International Baccalaureate (IB):** A 2-year international high school diploma taught in English.
- Great if you may want to study abroad, e.g., in Ireland, the UK, or globally.

So, what should you do?

Here are a few guiding questions:

- Do you enjoy theoretical learning (reading, writing, analyzing)?
- Are you more hands-on and want to learn through doing?
- Do you plan to study at a university in Denmark or abroad?
- Do you want to start working sooner, or are you okay with a longer study path?

Suggested next steps:

1. **Visit educational fairs** (uddannelsesmesser) or **open house events** (åbent hus).
2. **Speak to a study counselor** (uddannelsesvejleder) through **UU-vejledningen** – they can offer personalized advice.
3. **Try internships (praktik)** or “bridge” programs (brobygning) to test different paths.
4. **Talk with your parents** about long-term plans, especially if studying in Ireland is a possibility.

If you tell me more about your interests—like favorite school subjects, hobbies, or any dream jobs—I can help narrow it down even further.